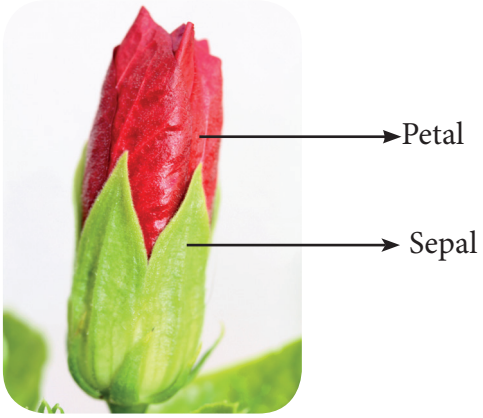
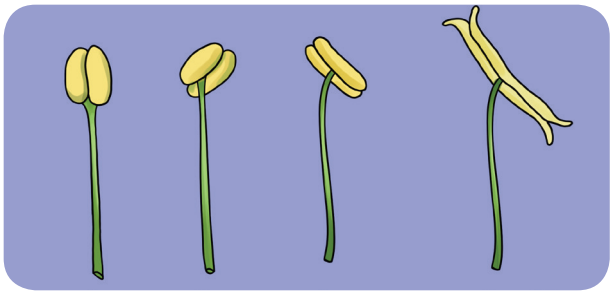


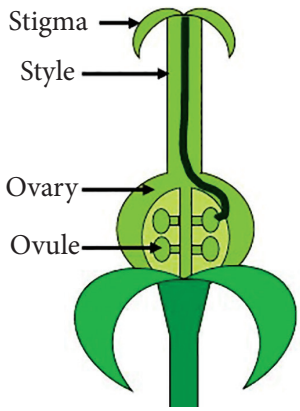
Sepal and Petal

Inside corolla, in **Hibiscus,** we can observe a long tube on which many stamens are arranged. But, in **Datura** we can see only five stalked structures, stamens. This ring or whorl of a flower is called **androecium.** Each stamens consists of two parts – a stalk called filament and a lobe called anther. If you touch these lobes in a mature flower, we can get a powdery substance called pollen grains (male reproductive part).



Androecium - Male part of the flower

Inside androecium whorl, we can find a female reproductive part of the flower, called gynoecium. You will find this part with a swollen bottom part.



Gynoecium – Female reproductive part

This is the ovary. Seeds are produced in this part. On top of the ovary there is a slender tube like structure called style. The top most sticky tip of the style is stigma. Pollen grains are received by the stigma. This is the fourth whorl of a flower.

5.2.2 Types of flowers

Flowers can be divided into two types. They are explained below.

Complete Flower

If all the four whorls - calyx, corolla, stamens and pistil are present, then it is called as complete flower. Complete flowers are bisexual flowers.

Incomplete Flower

If any of these four whorls is missing, then it is called as incomplete flower. Incomplete flowers are unisexual flowers. There are two types of unisexual flowers, **male flower** and **female flower**.

The flower with androecium and without gynoecium is called as **male flower** and the one with gynoecium and without androecium is known as **female flowers**.



Sunflower is not a single flower. It is a group of flowers clustered together. A group of flowers arranged together is called inflorescence. *Tridax procumbens*, looks like a single flower, but it is an inflorescence. Leaf juice of this plant is used to cure wounds and cuts.

ACTIVITY 4

Make a flower album

Collect some flowers and press them between pages of newspaper or book. Place two thick sheets and keep a heavy object, such as brick, on the top to apply pressure. Turn the sides every two to three days. Allow flowers to dry completely. Collect the dried flowers and paste them in an album. Now, your flower album is ready.